

AT A GLANCE

What began as a spectacle 18 years ago has now become one of the most valuable sports businesses in the world and, increasingly, an asset class

The IPL is now a sporting ecosystem that generates a revenue of over \$1.5 billion, which translates into 8% of India's entire sports industry

The original revenue model had centrally shared broadcasting revenue by the BCCI, match-day ticket sales, jersey sponsorships, and merchandise

The initial franchise owners were onboard for branding and had less knowledge of cricket. However, that changed over the years, and owners now come with knowledge of the game

While central revenues create a stable base, valuations diverge due to differences in cost structures and long-term earning potential. Older franchises enjoy higher profitability

The sponsors once bought a logo space on a jersey and called it a campaign. They now demand digital activation, co-branded content, and grassroots programmes

While central revenues create a stable base, valuations diverge due to differences in cost structures and long-term earning potential. Older franchises, having completed their bid payments, enjoy higher profitability, while newer teams like Gujarat Titans (GT) and Lucknow Super Giants (LSG) still carry instalment obligations. At the same time, legacy teams benefit from stronger brand recall and larger fan bases, which translate into higher sponsorship potential and premium valuations.

The BCCI owns the central rights and administers the league. The central commercial pool is split roughly as follows: around 50% retained by the BCCI, 45% shared equally among franchises, and 5% allocated as prize money.

The title sponsorship history tells the story of commercial acceleration better than any chart. DLF, the first title sponsor, paid ₹40 crore per season for the first four editions from 2008 to 2012. By 2024, Tata had to pay ₹500 crore per season, a more than 12-fold increase.

Media rights followed the same trajectory. The 2023–27 broadcast cycle was sold for ₹48,390 crore, nearly six times the ₹8,200 crore fetched in the first cycle.

The reason is simple: Reach. The 2025 edition of IPL reached approximately 1.1 billion unique viewers and delivered over 840 billion minutes of watch time. To put that in perspective: more than a billion people watched some portions of the cricket tournament.

As per the KPMG report, in 2024, overall sports sponsorships in India were valued at ₹7,421 crore, with the IPL alone commanding roughly half of all

